

### Gaim 1.3

Gaim gives you the flexibility that none of the other major IMs do. It allows cross-platform chatting using its multi-protocol option, which is functional on the Linux, BSD, MacOS X and Windows platforms. So you can log on to your multiple accounts using only one software, saving heaps of CPU resources. What's more, Gaim is open-source, and is compatible with the AIM, ICQ, MSN Messenger, Yahoo!, IRC, Jabber and Zephyr networks. You can now chat with your friends on Yahoo!, MSN or even IRC channels at the same time using the same instance of the chat window.

Gaim is fairly light on features, but has all the essentials such as file transfer (which doesn't work with all networks), Away messages, typing notification, and MSN window closing notification. One stand-out feature is that you can assign different buddies different sounds or actions when they come online.

Gaim, though not the best IM client we've seen, is stable and does all the small things chat software should. It's definitely the best of the 'other' software that provide cross-platform chatting.